



Factors in the Way of Interpersonal Effectiveness

☐ **YOU DON'T HAVE THE INTERPERSONAL SKILLS YOU NEED**

YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT YOU WANT

- ☐ You have the skills, but can't decide what you really want from the other person.
- ☐ You can't figure out how to balance your needs versus the other person's needs:
 - ☐ Asking for too much versus not asking for anything.
 - ☐ Saying no to everything versus giving in to everything.

YOUR EMOTIONS ARE GETTING IN THE WAY

- ☐ You have the skills, but emotions (anger, pride, contempt, fear, shame, guilt) control what you do.

YOU FORGET YOUR LONG-TERM GOALS FOR SHORT-TERM GOALS

- ☐ You put your immediate urges and wants ahead of your long-term goals. The future vanishes from your mind.

OTHER PEOPLE ARE GETTING IN YOUR WAY

- ☐ You have the skills but other people get in the way.
- ☐ Other people are more powerful than you.
- ☐ Other people may be threatened or may not like you if you get what you want.
- ☐ Other people may not do what you want unless you sacrifice your self-respect, at least a little.

YOUR THOUGHTS AND BELIEFS ARE GETTING IN THE WAY

- ☐ Worries about negative consequences if you ask for what you want or say no to someone's request get in the way of acting effectively.
- ☐ Beliefs that you don't deserve what you want stop you in your tracks.
- ☐ Beliefs that others don't deserve what they want make you ineffective.